

HiveForce Labs

THREAT ADVISORY



ATTACK REPORT

Malware Distribution via Google PPC by IcedID Botnet Distributors

Date of Publication

January 2, 2023

Admiralty Code

A1

TA Number

TA2023001

Summary

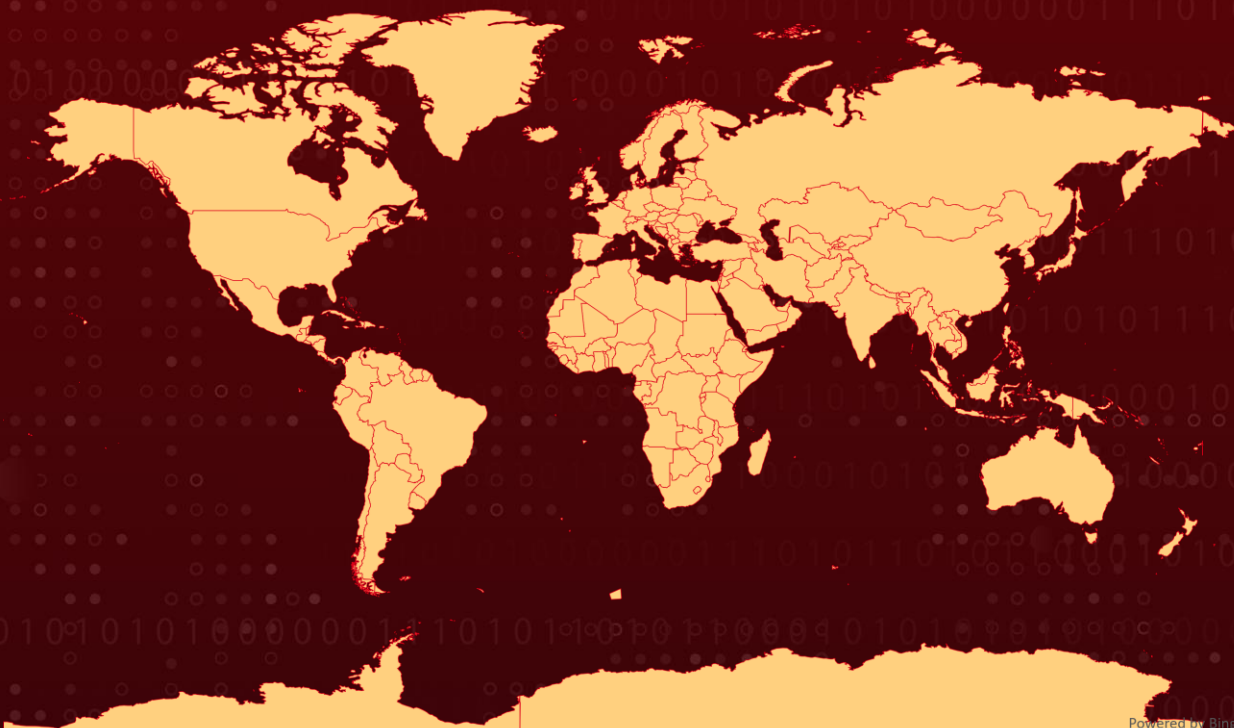
First appeared: December 2022

Attack Region: Worldwide

Attack: IcedID has been using Google pay-per-click advertisements to spread itself through malvertising attacks.



Attack Regions



Powered by Bing

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Attack Details

#1

The IcedID botnet has been using Google pay-per-click ads to distribute itself through malvertising attacks since December 2022. Malvertising involves the use of malicious ads that are displayed in search results and lure users into downloading malware. In these attacks, keywords are hijacked to display malicious ads that lure users into downloading the malware.

#2

The malicious websites where victims are directed are designed to look like the legitimate versions of these brands and applications. The IcedID malware is delivered through a series of steps that include the initial delivery of a loader, followed by the fetching of the bot core and the dropping of the payload, which is typically a backdoor.

#3

The botnet targets a variety of brands and applications, including Adobe, AnyDesk, Brave Browser, Chase Bank, Discord, Fortinet, GoTo, Libre Office, OBS Project, Ring, Sandboxie, Slack, Teamviewer, Thunderbird, and the US Internal Revenue Service. The IcedID malware is delivered through a malicious Microsoft Software Installer (MSI) or Windows Installer file inside a ZIP file.

#4

The new IcedID botnet loader is delivered via an MSI file and drops several files and invokes a malicious loader routine through rundll32.exe. The FBI has recently warned about how cybercriminals abuse search engine advertisement services to imitate legitimate brands and direct users to malicious sites for financial gain.

Recommendations



Security Leaders

Phishing simulations and routine education and awareness training and communications rarely account for MFA fatigue and web browser hygiene. Integrate and communicate all lessons learned.



Security Engineers

- **Uni5 Users:** This is an actionable threat advisory in HivePro Uni5. Prioritize and block all indicators attributed to the threat actors and attacks through your Command Center. Test your controls with Uni5's Breach & Attack Simulation.
- **All Engineers:** Refer to and action upon the 'Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs' & 'Indicators of Compromise (IoC)' on the following pages.

Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs

<u>TA0001</u> Initial Access	<u>TA0002</u> Execution	<u>TA0010</u> Exfiltration	<u>TA0008</u> Lateral Movement
<u>TA0005</u> Defense Evasion	<u>TA0004</u> Privilege Escalation	<u>TA0011</u> Command and Control	<u>TA0003</u> Persistence
<u>T1587.001</u> Malware	<u>T1204</u> User Execution	<u>T1204.002</u> Malicious File	<u>T1574</u> Hijack Execution Flow
<u>T1105</u> Ingress Tool Transfer	<u>T1587</u> Develop Capabilities	<u>T1588</u> Obtain Capabilities	<u>T1588.001</u> Malware
<u>T1218</u> System Binary Proxy Execution	<u>T1218.007</u> Msixexec	<u>T1218.011</u> Rundll32	<u>T1027</u> Obfuscated Files or Information
<u>T1027.009</u> Embedded Payloads	<u>T1036</u> Masquerading	<u>T1189</u> Drive-by Compromise	

Indicator of Compromise (IOCs)

TYPE	VALUE
SHA256	5555cbff358f0ff3f0fe79951f9c67fcc14369777159925f7322549952d18c51 8d5385fe63487a8852a14786a5626c58e7b2f3eb0011089ced22b2a6784ac301 7405c72fac4b0184e96209bbc9dd54bce1aa119b83b4842c18b2f34805995f76 4ce1f31bca21063147a84956b4391a85b78db30f3d973447f138c6e5154fb7a4
IPV4	143.198.92[.]88
Domains	estrabornhot[.]com klepdrafooip[.]com trbiriumpa[.]com lilsakainrot[.]com

References

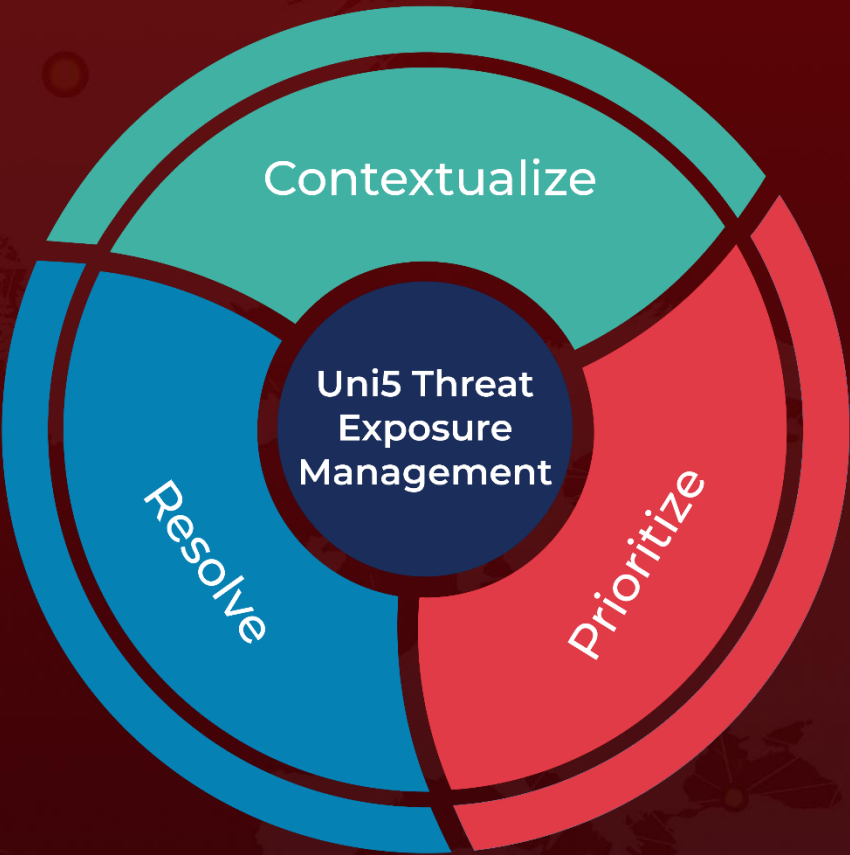
https://www.trendmicro.com/en_us/research/22/l/icedid-botnet-distributors-abuse-google-ppc-to-distribute-malware.html

<https://www.ic3.gov/Media/Y2022/PSA221221>

What Next?

At Hive Pro, it is our mission to detect the most likely threats to your organization and to help you prevent them from happening.

Book a free demo with HivePro Uni5: Threat Exposure Management Platform.



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January 2, 2023 • 7:15 AM

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